

ENGLISH LANGUAGE

MODERN ENGLISH (891)

PAPER 1 (Theory)

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: Three Hours

Reading Time: Additional Fifteen Minutes

Instructions to Candidates

1. You are allowed an additional **fifteen minutes** for **only** reading the question paper.
2. You must **NOT** start writing during reading time.
3. This question paper has 5 printed pages.
4. It has **four** questions in all.
5. Answer **all** questions.
6. You are advised to spend not more than 45 minutes on Question 1, 55 minutes on Question 2, 30 minutes on Question 3 and 50 minutes on Question 4.
7. While answering Multiple Choice Questions in Question 4, you are required to write only **one** option as the answer.
8. You should begin each answer on a fresh page.
9. The intended marks for questions are given in brackets [].

Instruction to Supervising Examiner

1. Kindly read aloud the Instructions given on page 1 to all the candidates present in the examination hall.

Question 1

Write a composition (in approximately 400 – 450 words) on any one of the following subjects. [20]

(You are reminded that you will be rewarded for the orderly and coherent presentation of the matter, use of appropriate style and general accuracy of spelling, punctuation and grammar.)

- (i) After weeks of scorching heat, the first heavy rain of the season fell on your city one afternoon. Describe what you saw and heard, first from your balcony and then on the street, and how the city changed within an hour. Express your feelings as the rain stopped.
- (ii) A cyclone struck your area and many families lost their homes. Narrate how you and your friends organised a collection of relief material for them, and what you learnt from the experience.
- (iii) Online shopping is killing local markets. Argue either FOR or AGAINST the given statement.
- (iv) Memories
- (v) 'It is not the destination but the journey that matters.' Present your reflections on this statement.
- (vi) Write an original short story that ends with the following words:
... As the train pulled away, I realised I had never even asked her name.

Question 2

- (i) Your school magazine is running a series called 'Lives Worth Reading'. Write a review of a biography or an autobiography that you have read recently, in about 250 – 300 words, based on the following guidelines: [15]
- the title, the author and the person the book is about – the period and setting of that life – the main events the book describes – the qualities of the person that stand out – the author's style, and one passage you remember – your rating and recommendation
- (ii) As a member of the Student Council of your school, you wish to start a Wellness Club that would help students manage stress and look after their mental and physical health. Write a proposal in not more than 150 words, stating the steps you would take to make it a success. [10]

Question 3

Answer subparts (i), (ii) and (iii).

- (i) Rewrite the following sentences according to the instructions given after each of them in brackets. [5]
- (a) As soon as the lights in the planetarium dimmed, the children stopped whispering.
(Begin: Hardly ...)
- (b) The rope was so long that it could reach the bottom of the well.
(Use: ... enough ...)
- (c) Tagore is more widely read than most other Bengali poets.
(Begin: Very few ...)
- (d) Although the ground was wet, the match started on time.
(Begin: In spite of ...)
- (e) If he had listened to the doctor, he would have recovered sooner.
(Begin: Had ...)
- (ii) In the following sentences, replace the INCORRECT underlined words to make the sentences meaningful and grammatically correct. Do not copy the sentences. [5]
- (a) The baby takes over her grandmother; she has exactly the same laugh.
- (b) When the manager retired, his deputy took after the running of the department.
- (c) The pilgrims set up for the temple long before sunrise.
- (d) The villagers set off a small library in the community hall.
- (e) The whole family came to the airport to see me through.
- (f) The task was difficult, but she was determined to see it off.
- (g) The two brothers fell through over the division of their land.
- (h) Our plans for the picnic fell out when the bus failed to arrive.
- (i) The shopkeeper politely turned up my request for a refund.
- (j) Only ten guests turned down at the party, although we had invited fifty.

- (iii) Fill in the blanks in the passage given below with the appropriate form of the verb given in brackets. Do not write the passage but write the verbs in the correct order. [5]

Sir Isaac Newton _____ (1) (be) famous for his absent-mindedness. One morning his housekeeper, who _____ (2) (cook) his breakfast every day for years, had to go out, so she _____ (3) (leave) an egg beside a pan of boiling water and _____ (4) (ask) him to boil it for exactly three minutes. The scientist nodded without looking up from the problem that had been troubling him since dawn.

When she returned, she found the great man _____ (5) (stand) by the stove, _____ (6) (stare) thoughtfully at the egg, which was still _____ (7) (clasp) in his hand. In the pan, his gold watch was bubbling merrily, and a small puddle had formed where the water had boiled over onto the floor.

“Sir, what are you doing?” she cried. Newton looked up, puzzled. “I _____ (8) (time) the egg, of course,” he replied. “It _____ (9) (need) three minutes, does it not?” The poor housekeeper did not know whether to laugh or to _____ (10) (scold) him. In the end she did both, and then she boiled the egg herself.

Question 4

Read the passage given below and answer the questions (i), (ii) and (iii) that follow.

- (1) Nothing ever happened at Chhotapur. Two trains stopped there each day, one going up in the morning and one coming down in the evening, and between them the station master, Mr Gopal Dutta, grew roses along the platform, the porter slept on a bench, and the station cat, a large ginger animal called Sultan, sat on the ticket window and inspected the passengers. Passengers were rare, and most of them were goats travelling to market with their owners. 5
- (2) So when a telegram announced that Mr H. N. Bhowmick, Divisional Inspector of Stations, would visit on Thursday, the whole station fell into a panic. Mr Bhowmick’s fame had travelled down the line ahead of him. It was said that he carried the railway rule-book in his head, all nine hundred pages of it, and that he had once suspended a station master for wearing brown shoes with a black uniform. 10
- (3) For three days Chhotapur scrubbed itself. The platform was swept until the bricks shone, the fire buckets were filled, the timetable was repainted, and Sultan was shut in the parcels office, protesting loudly. The porter was given a new cap, and the roses were watered twice a day. Mr Dutta even set the station clock by the radio, so that it was correct to the second. 15
- (4) The Inspector arrived on the morning train. He was a small, round man with a large moustache and a larger notebook, and he stepped onto the platform as though it had been built to insult him. He greeted no one. Instead he took out a gold pocket-watch, compared it with the station clock, and frowned. ‘Your clock is two minutes fast,’ he said.
- (5) ‘Sir, I set it by the radio only yesterday—’ 20
- (6) ‘My watch,’ said Mr Bhowmick, ‘has been accurate for twenty-two years. It belonged to my father, who was also an Inspector. Set the clock by my watch.’ And the station clock was set back two minutes.
- (7) Then the inspection began, and it lasted all day. Mr Bhowmick measured the letters on the name-board and found them a quarter of an inch too short. He counted the fire buckets twice. He discovered that they contained water, whereas a circular of 1961 required sand. He noted that the roses did not appear in the station’s list of property, and demanded to know by what authority they were growing on railway land. When Sultan escaped from the 25

parcels office and strolled across the platform, the Inspector wrote for a long time, and then asked to see the cat's papers.

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- (8) Mr Dutta answered every question humbly. The porter, who had never been so awake in his life, carried a chair behind the Inspector wherever he went. By five o'clock the notebook was full, and Mr Bhowmick sat in the waiting room dictating a report that already ran to fourteen pages. Mr Dutta wrote it down in his best handwriting, and his hand had begun to ache.

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- (9) At twenty-eight minutes past five by the station clock, the evening train was heard in the distance. 'Your train, sir,' said Mr Dutta. 'It leaves at five thirty-two.'

- (10) 'Then I shall board it at five thirty-two,' said the Inspector, without looking up, 'and not a moment earlier. Punctuality, Dutta, is the soul of the railways. Paragraph fifteen.' The porter, still holding the chair, opened his mouth and then, wisely, shut it again.

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- (11) Paragraph fifteen concerned the correct folding of signal flags. While he dictated it, the guard of the train, who went by the railway's own time and not by Mr Bhowmick's, blew his whistle, and the train began to move. At five thirty-two precisely by his father's watch, the Inspector rose, buttoned his coat and walked onto the platform, just in time to see the red lamp of the last carriage disappear round the bend.

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- (12) There was no other train until morning. The Inspector spent the night on the waiting-room bench that his report had described as unfit for public use, while Sultan, who had forgiven nobody, sat on the windowsill and watched him. The report, it is said, never reached Headquarters. It is certain that the station clock was quietly set forward two minutes the next day. The roses are still there.

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(An original passage written for this sample paper)

- (i)(a) Find a single word from the passage that will exactly replace the underlined word or words in the following sentences. [3]

- (1) The secretary was removed from office for a time while the accounts were checked.
(2) After lunch the old dog walked in a slow, relaxed way into the garden.
(3) The old fisherman's forecast of the storm proved remarkably close to what actually happened.

- (i)(b) For each of the words given below, choose the correct sentence that uses the same word unchanged in spelling, but with a different meaning from that which it carries in the passage. [3]

- (1) **fast** (line 19)

- (A) My watch is ten minutes fast, so I am never late.
(B) Many people fast from sunrise to sunset during the holy month.
(C) We ate a quick breakfast at the station.
(D) The kitchen clock has been running fast since the power cut.

- (2) **papers** (line 30)

- (A) The police officer asked the driver to show his papers.
(B) The immigration officer checked our papers at the border.
(C) The newspapers carried the story on the front page.
(D) The professor has published several papers on climate change.

(3) **bend** (line 45)

- (A) The bus slowed down at the sharp bend in the road.
- (B) The river makes a wide bend just below the temple.
- (C) Bend your knees when you lift a heavy box.
- (D) He bent the wire into the shape of a hook.

(ii) Answer the following questions as briefly as possible in your own words.

(a) Why do you think the fourteen-page report 'never reached Headquarters'? [2]

(b) In your opinion, was Mr Bhowmick justified in having the station clock set by his watch? Give a reason for your answer. [2]

(c) Why did the Inspector miss the evening train? [2]

(iii) Summarise what the passage reveals about the character of Mr Bhowmick (paragraphs 4 to 8). [8]

You are required to write the summary in the grid form in about 100 words. The use of abbreviations and contractions will not be accepted. Failure to keep within the word limit will be penalised.

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